

under the Tweaks tab, enable Activate Cool Bits, Activate Hardware options, Activate AGP Options and Activate Display Orientations. Depending on the nVidia card you have, you should see several new options activated within the Detonator driver, including Clock Frequencies, AGP Settings and Hardware Options.

Hardware options

Hardware Options will let you reset the AGP settings on your machine. The motherboard setting is automatically detected and you can manually set your AGP setting to the highest value supported by your motherboard and graphics card.

Overclocking your nVidia

Overclocking your nVidia card might give your gaming a performance boost, but again, this needs to be done with caution. Keep in mind that if you recklessly overclock, your graphics card might go kaput.

By default, the overclock-

ing options are not exposed within the nVidia driver, but if you have enabled the Activate Cool Bits option through nVHardPage, you can run up the clock frequencies of your GPU and graphics memory.

To do so, click on the Clock Frequencies option. Enable the 'Allow clock frequency adjustments' option. You may need to reboot to enable it. Once enabled, you can change the Core Clock Frequency, which controls the frequency of the GPU. The Memory Clock Frequency controls the speed of the graphics memory on the card. Ideally, increase the frequencies by a factor of 2 to 5 MHz at a time and test the settings. Raise the levels of the GPU speed, as well as the graphics memory, synchronously. Remember, don't move the sliders by ridiculous intervals—you will damage the card. A little overclocking, on the other hand, may give you just that little boost you crave for. Also, watch out for excessive heat—it might make sense to get additional cooling fans mounted within the case.

TNT and TNT2 cards

If you have a TNT or TNT 2-level card, this will be of interest to you. While a lot of new games may demand no less than a GeForce class card, the fact remains that with a slight tweak, you could still command the best

from your TNT card. You may have a little trouble with the very newest Detonator drivers, since these have optimizations for the latest cards, and may tax TNT. Be on the lookout for older, stable drivers, such as those in the 20-series family.

Setting the cards

Set the AGP aperture size to

half or quarter your system RAM size. Now, open the nVidia settings and make these changes: Set Mipmap Levels to 'Best Performance'. Enable 'Enable Fog Table Emulation', under the Direct 3D Settings tab. If you have a powerful CPU, choose 'Default Color Depth' as 'Always use 32 bpp', otherwise choose 16 bpp.

GAME TWEAKS



Quake III

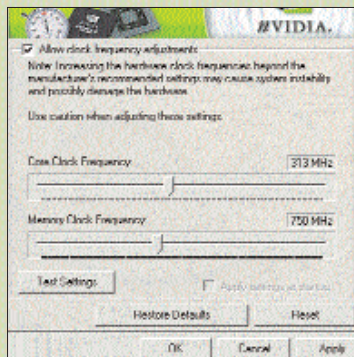
Advanced Tweaks

Simple tweaks can be set straight from within the game, and these commands should be entered at the console. The console is accessed by typing '~' during the game. To invoke the same settings every time, you could create a new document and enter all the desired settings. Then name it, say, custom.cfg. During game play, pull down the console and type '/exec custom.cfg' to load in your custom configuration file. You can also enter the settings into the q3config.cfg file, and invoke it automatically at

runtime. Make sure you precede each command setting with the word 'seta'.

The Gun: This command will allow you to toggle the gun display; for the best performance, turn off the gun display. Use `cg_drawGun 0` to turn it off, and `cg_drawGun 1` to turn it on.

Shelling hard: Though seeing the ejected shells popping out of your gun may feel realistic, it takes its toll on performance; to get the best, disable it by using `cg_brassTime 0` and `cg_brassTime 500` to turn it on. **Sixteen makes sense:** While you may be scoffing at run-



Overclock your nVidia card by dragging a few sliders, but be careful



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